Charcuterie Lab

FREE STARTER LIST

Make your own cheese advent calendar

12 nights, 6 cheeses, 6 spreads. Tick it off at the store.

HOW IT WORKS

1. Buy six cheeses (about 6 oz or 170 g each) and six jams or spreads.
2. Cut each cheese in two, so every cheese comes back a second time with a different spread.
3. Wrap each portion in parchment, then foil or a small bag. Number them 1 to 12.
4. Each night, take out one portion (soft 20–30 min, firm 30–45, aged 45–60 min before) and eat it with its spread and a few crackers.

SHOPPING LIST (CLASSIC VERSION)

Cheeses (6 oz / 170 g each)

- ☐ Brie or Camembert soft
- ☐ Aged English-style cheddar firm
- ☐ Manchego aged
- ☐ Stilton blue
- ☐ Wensleydale with cranberries fun
- ☐ Gruyère alpine

Spreads (one jar each)

- ☐ Fig jam
- ☐ Quince paste (membrillo)
- ☐ Hot honey
- ☐ Cherry preserves
- ☐ Onion jam
- ☐ Apricot preserves

Also

- ☐ 2 boxes of plain crackers
- ☐ A marker or 12 number tags
- ☐ Parchment paper and foil
- ☐ Nuts, fruit or bread for the side (optional)

TWO RULES THAT KEEP IT GOOD

Eat the soft and blue cheeses in the first week. Wrapped firm and aged cheese keeps the full 12 nights in the fridge (about 3–4 weeks once cut, per the American Dairy Association). Pregnant? Choose pasteurized hard cheeses, per the CDC.

Want the whole calendar planned?

The DIY Cheese Advent Calendar Kit has budget, classic and splurge shopping lists, a night-by-night pairing schedule for 12 or 24 nights, cut-out number tags, a tasting card and a Christmas Eve finale board. Find it at charcuterielab.com/shop.